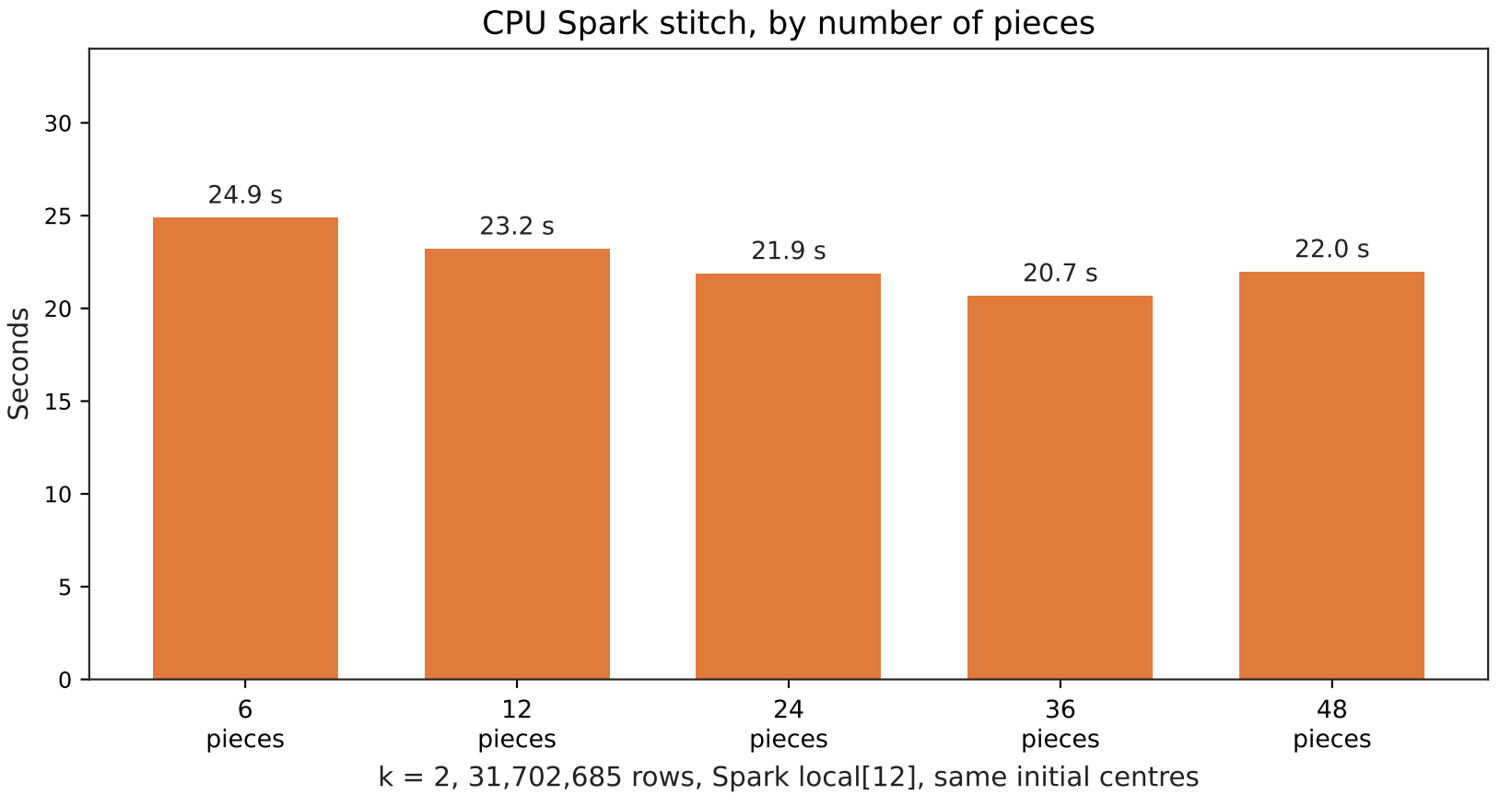

Each piece clusters alone, then Lloyd stitches the local centres. Stop at a centre shift of 1e-4.

6 pieces leaves half the workers idle, 24.9 s. 36 pieces is the fastest here, 20.7 s. 48 pieces is 22.0 s.

The file is in year order, so another cut is another answer. Distance to the full-file centres:

6 pieces 1.534, 12 pieces 1.489, 24 pieces 1.453, 36 pieces 1.280, 48 pieces 1.486.

The 12-piece centres match the earlier run. That earlier stage, on its own, was 22.2 s.